Dear Hiring Team at Halden Pay,

I am applying for the Senior Data Engineer – Data Platform position. I bring experience designing and operating production data platforms and cloud data warehouses at scale, with hands-on work across Python, SQL, Airflow, dbt, Kafka and cloud data warehouses. Halden Pay's focus on a shared platform and on taking ownership while reducing unnecessary complexity strongly matches the way I approach data engineering.

At Lukovac Freight Hub, I own ingestion and orchestration across Airflow, Snowflake, dbt and Kafka. I also participate in the data-platform on-call rotation and mentor two engineers, giving me direct experience operating shared production systems and supporting the engineers who use them. I designed and built a shipment-event pipeline processing around 30 million events per day, with end-to-end latency under two minutes at p95, and added replay tooling to recover failed events without data loss. I also migrated approximately 300 stored procedures into tested and documented dbt models, reducing the nightly warehouse build from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 35 minutes. These projects have involved building reusable platform capabilities and improving the reliability and efficiency of systems used by others.

Earlier, at Kovalent Pay, I built PySpark batch jobs on AWS EMR and designed Redshift warehouse solutions. I developed a transaction reconciliation engine matching bank settlement files against internal ledgers, reducing the finance team's manual work from approximately three days to four hours per month-end. I have also worked with Great Expectations on data quality, and have built tested and documented dbt models with incremental processing and CI checks. I earned the AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate certification, and contributed fixes and tests to an open-source Airflow provider. I would bring this practical cloud and open-source experience to a platform built around Airflow, dbt and Python.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience building reusable data-platform capabilities, operating cloud data warehouses, improving data quality, and delivering payment reconciliation systems could contribute to Halden Pay's Data Platform team.

Kind regards,

Lena Varga-Holm